And it is reliability that we need, not certainty. We don't have absolute certainty, and never will have it – unless we accept blind belief. The most credible answers are the ones given by science, because science *is* the search for the most credible answers available, not for answers pretending to certainty.

Though rooted in previous knowledge, science is an adventure based on continuous change. The story I have told reaches back over millennia, tracing a narrative of science that has treasured good ideas but hasn't hesitated to throw ideas away when something which works better was found. The nature of scientific thinking is critical, rebellious and dissatisfied with a priori conceptions, with reverence and sacred or untouchable truth. The search for knowledge is not nourished by certainty: it is nourished by a radical distrust in certainty.

This means not giving credence to those who say they are in possession of the truth. For this reason, science and religion frequently find themselves on a collision course. Not because science pretends to know ultimate answers but precisely for the opposite reason: because the scientific spirit distrusts whoever claims to be the one *having* ultimate answers, or privileged access to Truth. This distrust is found to be disturbing in some religious quarters. It is not science which is disturbed by religion: there are certain religions that are disturbed by scientific thinking.

To accept the substantial uncertainty of our knowledge is to accept living immersed in ignorance and, therefore, in mystery, to accept living with questions to which we do not know the answers. Perhaps we don't know them yet or – who knows? – we never will.

To live with uncertainty may be difficult. There are those who prefer any certainty, even if unfounded, to the uncertainty which comes from recognizing our own limits. There are some who prefer to believe in a story just because it was believed by the tribe's ancestors rather than bravely to accept uncertainty.

Ignorance can be scary. Out of fear, we can tell ourselves calming stories: up there beyond the stars, there is an enchanted garden, with a gentle father who will welcome us into his arms. It doesn't matter if this is true, it is reassuring.

There is always, in this world, someone who pretends to tell us the ultimate answers. The world is full of people who say that they have The Truth. Because they have got it from the fathers; they have read it in a Great Book; they have received it directly from a god; they have found it in the depths of themselves. There is always someone who has the presumption to be the depository of Truth, neglecting to notice that the world is full of *other* depositories of Truth, each one with his own real Truth, different from that of